One module that's part of the standard library of Ruby deserves special mention, given its usage in Rails: YAML.

YAML

YAML[34] is a recursive acronym that stands for YAML Ain't Markup Language. In the context of Rails, YAML is used as a convenient way to define the configuration of things such as databases, test data, and translations. Here's an example:

```
development:
  adapter: sqlite3
  database: db/development.sqlite3
  pool: 5
  timeout: 5000
```

In YAML, indentation is important, so this defines `development` as having a set of four key-value pairs, separated by colons. While YAML is one way to represent data, particularly when interacting with humans, Ruby provides a more general way for representing data for use by applications.